DACS Test

File Specification

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Overview

This document contains the file specification for the DACS Test data source.

Test Definition for DACS interviewees

Identfier:	DACS
Created Date:	29/04/2025 04:36:00
Modified By:	Administrator
Modified Date:	01/05/2025 03:01:32
Version:	3

File Specification

File Type	Character-Separated Values (CSV). See CSV Format in the appendix for more details.
Separator Character		(Vertical Bar, ASCII Code 124)
File Content	The first line in the file should be a *header row*, i.e. a character-separated list of field names. The field names should appear in the order described in this document. The header should be followed by one or more *data rows*, i.e. lines of character-separated field values.
File Name Format	The file name must follow the following format: <Prefix>_<Period Date>_DACSV3.csv The file **prefix** is an alphanumeric string, usually the organisation name. It cannot contain underscores (_) or tildes (~). The **period date** is the point in time at which the data in the file is/was relevant, usually the date the data was extracted from the system. The date must be in the DDMMYYYY format, where DD represents the day (with a leading zero where appropriate), MM represents the month and YYYY represents the year. For example, the 3rd of May, 2019 should be written as 03052019. If multiple files are to be loaded with the same period date, then the prefix must be unique within the set of files. For example, if the data is being sent in two parts, they might be named **MyOrg1**_03052019_DACS.csv and **MyOrg2**_03052019_DACS.csv.

Fields Summary

Each row of data for loading into the DACS Test data source should contain values for the following fields:

Position	Name	Data Type
1	UPN	Text
2	First Name	Text
3	Middle Names	Text
4	Surname	Text
5	Address	Text
6	NINO	Text
7	DOB	DateTime
8	Case Notes	Text
9	Arrears	Money
10	Credit	Money
11	Number of Dependents	Integer
12	Gender	Text

Fields Detail

UPN

Unique person reference

Position	1
Name	UPN
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	The text must be at least 1 character(s) long. The text cannot be greater than 8000 character(s) long.
Mandatory	Yes
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

First Name

Subject first name

Position	2
Name	First Name
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	The text cannot be greater than 8000 character(s) long.
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Middle Names

Subject middle names

Position	3
Name	Middle Names
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	The text cannot be greater than 8000 character(s) long.
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Surname

Subject surname

Position	4
Name	Surname
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	The text cannot be greater than 8000 character(s) long.
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Address

Subject address

Position	5
Name	Address
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	The text cannot be greater than 8000 character(s) long.
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

NINO

Subject national insurance number

Position	6
Name	NINO
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	null
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

DOB

Subject date of birth

Position	7
Name	DOB
Data Type	DateTime

Personal Identifier	Yes
Constraints	The date should be formatted using the pattern 'dd/MM/yyyy'.
Mandatory	Yes
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Case Notes

Allocated worker case notes

Position	8
Name	Case Notes
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	No
Constraints	The text cannot be greater than 8000 character(s) long.
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Arrears

Amount subject is in arrears

Position	9
Name	Arrears
Data Type	Money
Personal Identifier	No
Constraints	Pound sterling (GBP). If present, the value must represent a sum of money (e.g. £1, 12.50 or 100 GBP).
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Credit

Amount subject is in credit

Position	10
Name	Credit
Data Type	Money
Personal Identifier	No
Constraints	Pound sterling (GBP). If present, the value must represent a sum of money (e.g. £1, 12.50 or 100 GBP).
Mandatory	No

Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Number of Dependents

Number of dependents in household

Position	11
Name	Number of Dependents
Data Type	Integer
Personal Identifier	No
Constraints	If present, the value must be a whole number (e.g. 1 or 207).
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Gender

Subject gender

Position	12
Name	Gender
Data Type	Text
Personal Identifier	No
Choices	See: Choices for Gender
Mandatory	No
Default Value	
Error Action	Reject row - Invalid field value retained, error reported for manual fixing

Choices for Gender

If present, the field value must be one of the values from the table below.

Value	Description
M	Male
F	Female
O	Other
X	Unknown

Appendix

CSV Format

Character-Separated Values (CSV) files containing data for loading into the DACS Test data source should be formatted as follows:

- **UTF-8 Character Encoding** – a variable width character encoding capable of representing over a million different characters. It shares the first 128 code points with ASCII, so any valid ASCII document is a valid UTF-8 document.

  Note: Many other common 1-byte-per-character encoding such as ISO-8859-1 (Latin-1) and Windows-1252 also share the first 128 code points with ASCII, so these will often pass for valid UTF-8. However, non-ASCII characters (e.g. a-acute or á) encoded in a character encoding other than UTF-8 will not be decoded properly and will result in corrupt or missing data.

  The byte order mark (BOM) is optional.

- **One row per line** – each row of data must appear on one line, i.e.:

  - ✕ Fields cannot contain new line characters, and
  - ✕ There should be no new line characters between fields.

  Note: new line characters in field values and between fields will be detected and removed.

- **Field values that contain a delimiter character must be enclosed in double quotes** (“).

  The opening and closing quotes will be discarded when the field value is read. If the field value contains double quotes as well as the delimiter, the double quotes in the field value must be escaped by using **two consecutive double quotes to denote one literal double quote**.

- **The CSV file should <u>not</u> contain ASCII control characters except for:**

  - ✓ horizontal tab (\t)
  - ✓ line-feed (\n)
  - ✓ carriage return (\r)

  All other control characters will be removed.

Supported Data Types

Name	Description
Text	Character data, such as letters, numbers and punctuation. The text cannot be greater than 8,000 characters long.
Integer	A whole number. The minimum value is -9,223,372,036,854,775,808 and the maximum value is 9,223,372,036,854,775,807. Integers represented as a fraction are permitted, such as 1.0.
Decimal	A decimal number. The minimum value is -1.7976931348623157E308 and the maximum value is 1.7976931348623157E308. Integers are permitted.
Money	A decimal number with currency information, such as £1.50 and 5 GBP.
DateTime	A date and/or time value, such as '25/12/2018', '25 DEC 18', '2018-12-25 14:30:01' and '02:30:01 PM'. Every DateTime values requires a **date and time pattern**, such as 'dd/MM/yyyy', 'dd MMM yy', 'yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm:ss' and 'hh:mm:ss a'. Xantura supports all patterns supported by **Java SimpleDateFormat**, the full details can be found here.
Boolean	A Boolean data types restricts the field value to one of two choices, such as true/false and yes/no. The choices are configurable.
Void	Fields with a void data type are ignored by Xantura.